Braylon Watson

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EDUCATION

University of Arkansas - Fayetteville, AR Expected Dec 2026
B.A. Computer Science, Minor in Finance

TECHNICAL SKILLS

Languages: Python, SQL, C++
Frameworks/Architectures: REST APIs, CRUD Operations, Git, Low-Latency Optimization

EXPERIENCE

University of Arkansas IT Services - Fayetteville, AR Aug 2026 - Present
IT Services Co-op Intern

- Develop and maintain Azure DevOps CI/CD pipelines for university applications built with .NET, Python, and React.
- Automate dependency installation, application builds, artifact generation, and deployment to Azure Web Apps through YAML-based pipelines.
- Evaluate branching, pull-request, and deployment strategies to separate development/testing environments from production releases.

Bryant Public Schools - Bryant, AR May 2022 - Aug 2022
IT Intern

- Diagnosed and resolved hardware and software issues across district systems.
- Supported technical operations and communicated with staff to troubleshoot user issues.

PROJECTS

CoordinAIte - AI Football Decision-Support Platform
Python, FastAPI, PostgreSQL, React, XGBoost, Docker, AWS

- Built a full-stack machine learning platform using FastAPI, PostgreSQL, React, and XGBoost to predict offensive tendencies and generate real-time defensive recommendations from NFL play-by-play data, achieving approximately 70% accuracy across 28,000+ plays.
- Containerized FastAPI services with Docker and deployed them through AWS ECR and ECS/Fargate behind an Application Load Balancer, using RDS PostgreSQL for centralized persistence and enabling horizontally scalable API workloads.
- Developed REST APIs and persistent game-session infrastructure while integrating Stripe subscriptions, authentication, and tier-based feature access into the production application.

AI Shelf Monitoring System - Computer Vision / Object Detection
Python, YOLOv8, Ultralytics, OpenCV, Label Studio

- Built and trained a custom YOLOv8 object-detection system to monitor retail shelf inventory and classify shelf conditions as Stocked, Almost Empty, or Empty, using a custom-labeled image dataset created with Label Studio.
- Developed a video inference pipeline to process shelf footage, generate real-time detections and confidence scores, and track inventory-state transitions for automated low-stock and restock alerting.

LEADERSHIP & ACTIVITIES

University of Arkansas Football - Division I Student-Athlete

- Balanced Division I athletics with rigorous Computer Science coursework while demonstrating discipline, teamwork, and time management.